



Lesson 200: The Law of Total Tricks

1 CENTRAL FORMULA

TOTAL TRICKS = sum of total trumps
between the two partnerships

EXAMPLE: we have **8** trumps + they have **8** trumps = **16** total tricks
(divided between the two partnerships)

2 LEVEL OF SAFETY

TOTAL TRUMPS IN LINE	LEVEL OF SAFETY (SAFE TO BID)
8 trumps in line	LEVEL 2 (safe to bid at level 2)
9 trumps in line	LEVEL 3 (safe to bid at level 3)
10 trumps in line	LEVEL 4! (safe to bid at level 4!)

3 FLAT DISTRIBUTIONS



WARNING!

**5332, 4333 =
DISADVANTAGEOUS
DISTRIBUTIONS,
NEED CAUTION**

- Fewer tricks than the Law predicts.

4 BONUS



Singleton in
opponent's suit

= +1 extra trick



Double fit
(fit in two suits)

= +1 extra trick

5

NORTH

A K Q J 10 9 4 2
5 TRUMPS

WE HAVE
9
TRUMPS
(NORTH-SOUTH)

WEST

THEY HAVE
7
TRUMPS
(EAST-WEST)

EAST

A Q J 10 9 8 3 2
4 TRUMPS

SOUTH

LEVEL 3 SAFE!

6

SUMMARY



COUNT
the trumps.



CHECK
the distribution.



CHOOSE
the right
level!



**GOOD PLANNING
LEADS TO MORE
TRICKS!**



Maestro Franci